

Small Business Cybersecurity Readiness Checklist

A practical review of identity, devices, email, backups, network security, and employee access.

How to Use This Checklist

Use this checklist to quickly identify whether a business has the basic controls needed to reduce common cyber risk. A “no” answer does not always mean a system is failing, but it does indicate an area that should be reviewed before it becomes a business problem.

Security Readiness Checklist

Identity	Are all users protected by MFA, especially administrators?	Yes / No / Unknown
Identity	Are stale accounts, former employees, and shared logins removed or controlled?	Yes / No / Unknown
Devices	Does the business have an accurate device inventory?	Yes / No / Unknown
Devices	Are laptops/desktops encrypted and protected by endpoint security?	Yes / No / Unknown
Email	Are phishing, impersonation, and malicious attachments filtered?	Yes / No / Unknown
Backups	Have backups been restored and tested recently?	Yes / No / Unknown
Network	Is remote access secured without exposing unnecessary services?	Yes / No / Unknown
Policies	Is onboarding/offboarding documented and repeatable?	Yes / No / Unknown
Training	Do employees receive security awareness training?	Yes / No / Unknown
Reporting	Does leadership receive recurring security/technology reporting?	Yes / No / Unknown

Fast Scoring Guide

- 0-2 Unknown/No answers: basic posture may be acceptable but should still be validated.
- 3-5 Unknown/No answers: schedule a focused security review.
- 6+ Unknown/No answers: treat as a priority risk review before a preventable issue becomes expensive.

Recommended Next Step

Use the checklist results to decide whether the business needs a targeted standalone service or broader managed IT/security ownership through the ProActive Ecosystem model.

CTA: Request a Cyber Risk Assessment if multiple items are unknown or marked no.